TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Explain the Difference Between Two Options

Explain | Difference | Information Briefing

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Explain how two options differ: what is the same, two differences and what they mean for the listener, with a reason or an example, and leave the choice to them.

WHO You and Mei Ling work in accounts in a small JB company that sells office furniture. You both check the staff medical claims every month.

SITUATION Ali has just joined as the IT person. Siti gave him the medical form: panel card or claim-back. Kumar uses claim-back; he paid RM85 at a clinic last month and is still waiting for his money.

NEED Ali asks you: 'What's the difference?' He must choose by Friday and keep his choice for the whole year. He wants to understand, then choose himself.

GOAL Explain what is the same, the two differences and what they mean for Ali, with a reason and an example. Do not choose for him. Check he understood and answer his questions.

Panel card

- Up to RM1,000 a year
- Only the 15 panel clinics in JB
- Pay nothing at the clinic

Claim-back

- Up to RM1,000 a year
- Any clinic
- Pay first, claim by the 25th, paid once a month

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Ali asks: “Siti gave me this medical form: panel card or claim-back. I don’t really get it. What’s the difference?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Both options pay for your clinic visits, up to RM1,000 a year. You choose one on Siti’s form by Friday, and you keep it for the whole year. The first difference is where you can go. The card works only at the 15 panel clinics in JB, but with claim-back, you can go to any clinic. The second difference is money. With the card, you pay nothing. With claim-back, you pay first, so you wait for your money, because claims are paid only once a month. For example, Kumar paid RM85 last month, and he’s still waiting. So claim-back gives you more choice, but with the card, you never wait. It’s up to you. Is that clear?

1 WHAT IS THE SAME

2 DIFFERENCE 1

3 DIFFERENCE 2

4 WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Kumar tells a customer how two office chairs differ. Order: Same → Difference 1 → Difference 2 → What it means.

- [ ] Both chairs are the same size, and both have a two-year warranty.
- [ ] The first difference is the price. The black one is RM320, but the grey one is RM450.
- [ ] The second difference is the back. The grey one has a mesh back, so it's cooler on a hot afternoon.
- [ ] So the black one costs less, but the grey one is cooler. It's up to you. Any questions?

Write the letter: **1** = What is the same · **2** = Difference 1 · **3** = Difference 2 · **4** = What it means for you

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SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY WHAT IS THE SAME

- [ ] Both options …
- [ ] They both …
- [ ] … is the same for both.

SAY THE DIFFERENCE

- [ ] The first difference is …
- [ ] The second difference is …
- [ ] With A, …, but with B, …
- [ ] A is cheaper / slower than B.

GIVE A REASON OR AN EXAMPLE

- [ ] …, because …
- [ ] …, so …
- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] …, but … / However, …

SAY WHAT IT MEANS

- [ ] So for you, …
- [ ] A gives you more …, but …
- [ ] It depends on what you need.
- [ ] It's up to you.

CHECK UNDERSTANDING

- [ ] Is that clear?
- [ ] Shall I say that again?
- [ ] Any questions?
- [ ] Can you tell me the two differences?

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. The card works only at 15 panel clinics. [because / so / but] With claim-back, you can go to any clinic.

2. Claim-back is slower. [because / so / but] Claims are paid only once a month.

3. With claim-back, you pay the clinic first. [because / so / For example,] You wait for your money.

4. With claim-back, you wait for your money. [Because / But / For example,] Our colleague Kumar is still waiting for his RM85.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Both options _____ up to RM1,000 a year. (A fact about both options)
   ○ pay ○ paying ○ pays
2. With claim-back, Kumar _____ first and claims later. (What one person does)
   ○ paying ○ pays ○ pay
3. Claim-back is _____ than the panel card. (Comparing two things (short word))
   ○ slowest ○ more slow ○ slower
4. Claim-back gives you _____ choice than the card. (Comparing an amount)
   ○ much ○ more ○ most

SLIDE 09 Both · -er than · more · but

To explain a difference, say what is true for both, then put the two options side by side with 'but' and a comparison.

Both options **pay** up to RM1,000 a year.

Claim-back is **slower than** the card.

Claim-back gives you **more** choice, **but** with the card, you never wait.

You pay nothing, **but** you need a panel clinic. = You pay nothing. **However**, you need a panel clinic.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

1 WHAT IS THE SAME

Both options …

2 DIFFERENCE 1

The first difference is … With the card, …, but with claim-back, …

3 DIFFERENCE 2

The second difference is …, because …

4 WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

For example, … So for you, … It's up to you. Is that clear?

SLIDE 11

Information Briefing

The speaker explains how two options differ, from mixed-up notes, without choosing. The listener fills the note (the same, two differences), then chooses and says why.

1. Round 1 (3:00). Speaker: say your card number. Listener: say your situation. Speaker: explain, don't choose, check.
2. Listener: fill in the note. A line empty? Ask 'Is anything else different?' Then say your choice and why.
3. Round 2 (2:00): listeners move one seat. Same card to a new listener, shorter: the same, two differences.
4. Round 3 (1:00), frames closed: listeners move again, to a card already in their note, and check it. Then swap roles.

Card 1 · Sending parcels with Quick Send

Card 2 · Two phone plans

Card 3 · Excel course for staff

Card 4 · Air-conditioner for a room

Listener's note: two options

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Same			
Difference 1			
Difference 2			
My choice + why			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Ali asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. When do I have to give Siti the form?
2. Why is claim-back so slow?
3. Can I change to the other option in June?

Start with: **By …** · **Because …** · **No, … / Yes, …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your mother is going to a wedding in KL on Saturday. She asks the difference between the bus from Larkin and going by car. Both get her there before the dinner at 7 p.m. Bus: about RM45, about 5 hours. Car: about RM150 for petrol and tolls, about 4 hours. Explain, and let her choose.

Both … · **The first difference is …** · **With the bus, …, but with the car, …** · **So for you, … It's up to you.**

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says what is the same and two differences, so the listener can fill in the note.
- [ ] Gives a reason or an example for a difference and says what it means for the listener.
- [ ] Leaves the choice to the listener and checks that they understood.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

The same and two differences	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason, example and meaning	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Leaving the choice and checking	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · Sending parcels with Quick Send

You are Kumar. From Monday you send the sales parcels, about 10 a day. You don't drive to work, and the parcels are packed by 3 p.m. Fill the note, ask one question, then choose.

Card 2 · Two phone plans

You are the speaker's cousin. You cross the Causeway to work three days a week, and you want to pay as little as you can each month. Fill the note, ask one question, then choose.

Card 3 · Excel course for staff

You are Mei Ling. You look after your two young children at weekends, and you learn best when you can ask a question. Fill the note, ask one question, then choose.

Card 4 · Air-conditioner for a room

You are a friend. You are moving into a rented room for one year only, and you want to spend as little as possible this year. Fill the note, ask one question, then choose.

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · Sending parcels with Quick Send

Pick-up: RM9 a parcel (you pay for the driver) · Both: next-day delivery · Drop-off: you drive them to the shop, 10 min away, open till 6 p.m. · Both: tracking number · Drop-off: RM6 a parcel · Pick-up: driver comes at 4 p.m.

Card 2 · Two phone plans

Prepaid: RM35 every 30 days · Both: unlimited calls, 60 GB of data · Postpaid: free roaming in Singapore (5 GB a day) · Both: no contract · Prepaid: no roaming (your data stops at the border) · Postpaid: RM68 a month

Card 3 · Excel course for staff

Classroom: 2 Saturdays, 9 to 5 · Both: the company pays · Online: twelve 1-hour videos, any time · Classroom: ask the trainer at once · Online: questions by email, answer in 2 days (the trainer is in class) · Both: certificate

Card 4 · Air-conditioner for a room

Standard: RM1,100 · Both: 1 hp, free installation · Inverter: power about RM40 a month (it slows down when the room is cool) · Both: 3-year warranty · Inverter: RM1,600 · Standard: power about RM65 a month (8 hours a night)